

FUSION PRACTICES · ORACLE PARTNER

PGR Platform

User Manual — Postgraduate Research Student Lifecycle Management

Phase 1 MVP · Built on React (Next.js 14) + FastAPI + PostgreSQL
Covers the full lifecycle: applicant → student → alumni, on one
preserved identity.

Version 0.1 · 2026-08-21

1. What this platform does

The PGR Platform manages the whole relationship between a person and the institution — from a research opportunity, through recruitment, admission, registration, supervision, progression, funding, thesis, examination, completion, and finally alumni status.

The central idea: the system tracks the *person*, not just the student. One person keeps the *same identity* (the same record) as they move from applicant to student to alumni — nothing is duplicated along the way.

Person → Research Opportunity → Application → Assessment → Offer → **Student** (same person) → Supervision → Progression milestones → Funding → Thesis → Examination → Completion → Graduation → **Alumni** (same person)

2. Getting started & signing in

Start the app

- Double-click `start-all.bat` in the project folder. It ensures PostgreSQL is running, starts the API and the web app, and opens your browser.
- The app opens at `http://localhost:3000`.

Sign in

Use one of the demo logins below. The **Administrator** sees everything; the **Supervisor** sees only their own students (see §9).

Role	Email	Password
Institution Administrator	admin@example.com	admin123
Supervisor	elena.ford@example.com	super123



PGR Platform
Sign in to continue

Email

admin@example.com

Password

.....

Sign in

Demo: admin@example.com / admin123

The sign-in screen. Demo credentials are pre-filled for convenience.

3. The dashboard

After signing in you land on the **Executive dashboard**. It shows live platform status and the key lifecycle metrics computed across all data — active researchers, applications in the pipeline, applicant→student conversion rate, funded students, theses, and completions — plus the **Administrator queues** (work waiting to be done).

PGR Platform

RESEARCH LIFECYCLE

WORKSPACE

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Progression

Funding

Thesis

Completion

ADMINISTRATION

Settings

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Dashboard

Executive dashboard

PGR lifecycle at a glance.

Platform connectivity

API reachable Database ok Signed in as admin@example.com Role Institution Administrator

Lifecycle metrics

ACTIVE RESEARCHERS

1

registered / active

APPLICATIONS

4

in pipeline

CONVERSION RATE

50%

applicant → student

FUNDED STUDENTS

1

active arrangement

THESES SUBMITTED

0

awaiting/under exam

COMPLETIONS

1

graduated

Administrator queues

AWAITING ASSESSMENT

2

applications

OFFERS TO ACCEPT

0

issued

REVIEWS DUE

0

progression

THESES SUBMITTED

0

to examine

admin

admin@example.com

Executive dashboard with live metrics and administrator queues.

4. Persons & the 360 view

Persons lists everyone the platform knows. Each person has identities they have held over time (applicant, student, alumni...). Search by name or email, then open a person to see their **360 view**: profile, the identities they have held, and a lifecycle timeline.

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admin
admin@example.com

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PGR Platform

> Persons

Persons

One person across every identity over time.

Q Search by name or email...

Name	Email	Nationality	Current identities
Marcus Bell	marcus.bell@example.ac.uk	Irish	student · current
Tom Fisher	tom.fisher@example.com	—	none
Elena Ford	elena.ford@example.com	British	none
Aisha Khan	aisha.khan@example.ac.uk	British	alumni · current
Priya Nair	priya.nair@example.com	Indian	alumni · current
Riya Sharma	riya.sharma@example.com	—	none

6 total

Persons list — current identities shown as coloured pills.

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Persons

Priya Nair

Person 360 — profile, identities, and lifecycle.

Back to persons

Profile

GIVEN NAME	FAMILY NAME	PREFERRED NAME
Priya	Nair	—
EMAIL	NATIONALITY	DATE OF BIRTH
priya.nair@example.com	Indian	—

Identities over time

student

2026-08-21 → 2026-08-21

alumni · current

2026-08-21 → current

Lifecycle timeline

Student (2026-08-21 to 2026-08-21)

2026-08-21

Alumni (2026-08-21 to current)

2026-08-21

admin

admin@example.com

Person 360 — the lifecycle timeline. The same person moved Student → Alumni; the record (and its `person_id`) never changed.

5. Recruitment

The **Recruitment** screen has two tabs. *Opportunities* lists research positions — create one with **New opportunity**, and move its status along its lifecycle with the **Move to...** control (draft → approved → open → recruiting → filled → closed). *Applications* shows the candidate pipeline with counts by stage.

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Recruitment

Opportunities and the application pipeline.

Opportunities

Applications

+ New opportunity

Title	Stipend	Positions	Status
PhD in Machine Learning for Healthcare	GBP 19,000	1	recruiting Move to...

Recruitment — opportunities with the status-transition control.

6. Application → offer → student

Open an application to **advance its stage**, **record an assessment**, and run the **offer flow**: Create offer → Issue → Accept. Accepting an offer creates the student *on the same person record* — the applicant becomes a student without any duplication.

- Advance the application to a later stage (e.g. *selected*).
- In the Offer panel: **Create offer** → **Issue** → **Accept** → **create student**.
- A confirmation shows the new student reference; the application is marked *converted*.

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Recruitment

Applications

Application

Assess, advance, and make an offer.

Back to recruitment

Overview

Applicant: Tom Fisher Route: opportunity led Stage

applicant

Advance stage

Target stage

Reason (optional)

Advance

Record assessment

Decision

recommended

Rationale

Record

Offer

No offer yet.

Create offer

Stage history

applicant

2026-08-21 13:21:37

Application detail — advance/assess actions, the offer lifecycle, and stage history.

7. Students

Students lists everyone registered on a research programme. Open a student to manage their whole journey from one page (next section).

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Students

The core PGR student record.

Student ref	Status	Mode	Start
PGR-2026-E5946D	completed	full time	2026-08-21
PGR-2026-1586FA	registered	full time	2026-08-21

2 total

Students list.

8. The student page — the heart of the platform

Everything about a student lives on one page: their record, **supervisors** (assign and end — history is preserved), **progression milestones** (submit and record panel decisions — a continuing decision generates the next milestone automatically), **funding** (arrangements over time — add, change, end), and **thesis & completion** (intention → submit → examination → confirm → graduate).

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Students

Marcus Bell

PGR student record.

Back to students

Record

STUDENT REF

PGR-2026-1586FA

STATUS

registered

STUDY MODE

full time

START DATE

2026-08-21

EXPECTED END

—

RESEARCH TOPIC

—

Supervisors

Elena Ford

primary

current

End

Choose a supervisor...

primary

Assign

Progression milestones

Induction Review

decided

progress

due 2026-09-20

Confirmation Review

decided

progress

due 2027-05-18

Annual Progress Review

not started

due 2028-02-12

Submit

Panel outcome...

Decide

Funding

research council

· GBP 21,000

active

2026-08-21 → current

Change

End

research council

· UKRI EPSRC · GBP 19,000

changed

2026-08-21 → 2026-08-21

research council

· GBP 25,000

active

2026-08-21 → current

Change

End

research council

Source (optional)

Stipend (GBP)

Add arrangement

Thesis & completion

Thesis

not started

Declare intention

Completion

pending

Confirm completion

Graduate

Thesis must be approved first.

Person

This student is Marcus Bell — the same person record carried over from their application (one person_id across identities).

The student page: supervisors, progression milestones, funding, and the thesis & completion flow — all in one place.

Graduating a student

- In **Thesis & completion**: Declare intention → Submit thesis → record the examination outcome (*pass* → approved).

- **Confirm completion**, then **Graduate**.
- Graduation records the award, **closes funding**, marks the student *completed*, and opens the **alumni** identity on the same person — closing the loop.

9. Progression configuration & roles

Configurable milestones

The **Progression** screen shows each programme's milestone definitions (e.g. Induction, Confirmation, Annual review). Student milestones are generated from these — so the progression flow is configured in data, not code.

The screenshot shows the PGR Platform interface. The top header includes the PGR Platform logo, a Fusion Practices Oracle Partner badge, and a navigation arrow. The left sidebar is divided into 'WORKSPACE' and 'ADMINISTRATION' sections. The 'WORKSPACE' section contains links to Dashboard, Persons, Recruitment, Admissions, Students, Supervision, Progression (highlighted), Funding, Thesis, and Completion. The 'ADMINISTRATION' section contains a link to Settings. The main content area is titled 'Progression' and includes a sub-header 'Configurable milestone flows per programme.' Below this, a text block explains that these are the milestone definitions each programme runs. A specific example is shown for 'PhD Computer Science', listing three milestones: 'Induction Review' (30 days after start), 'Confirmation Review' (270 days after start), and 'Annual Progress Review' (540 days after start). The bottom of the interface shows a user profile for 'admin' with the email 'admin@example.com' and a settings icon.

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admin
admin@example.com

Progression

Configurable milestone flows per programme.

These are the milestone definitions each programme runs. A student's milestones are generated from them; record submissions and panel decisions on the student's page.

PhD Computer Science

- Induction Review 30 days after start
- Confirmation Review 270 days after start
- Annual Progress Review 540 days after start

Progression — the configurable milestone flow per programme.

Roles & what each person sees (row-scoping)

Permissions decide what you can do; **scoping** decides which rows you see. Sign in as the **Supervisor** (`e1ena.ford@example.com`) and open **Students**: you'll see only the students that supervisor actually supervises — not everyone. This is enforced on the server, so it can't be bypassed from the browser. The Administrator sees all students.

Appendix — running & troubleshooting

Do this	File
Set up once (installs everything, seeds demo data)	<code>setup.bat</code>
Start the whole app + open the browser	<code>start-all.bat</code>
Stop everything	<code>stop.bat</code>
Run the automated tests	<code>test.bat</code>

The platform runs on PostgreSQL (database `pgr`). You can inspect the live data in DBeaver at `localhost:5432`. A step-by-step click-through is also in `docs/TEST_WALKTHROUGH.md`.

This manual covers the Phase 1 MVP. Phase 2 adds the workflow/notification engine, external-system integration (Finance/HR/Research), examiner management, statutory reporting, and student/supervisor portals.